of the mind–matter composite or ***buddhi***, that is merely observed by the conscious principle (***purusha***).

Further reading: Mookerjee 1975; Tillemans 1999

Advaita-Vedanta (theory that reality is non-differentiated): this is the religious philosophy of one who has renounced (***samnyasa***) involvement in everyday life and public religion in order to devote himself to salvation. It is a tradition of scriptural interpretation holding that the ***Upanishads*** teach that the self-revealing (*svasamvedana*) and self-established (***svatah siddha***) soul (***atman***), which is the constant witness (*sakshin*) of all mental events, is identical with the Authentic Reality or ***Brahman***, understood as unconditioned (***nirvishesha***) being and tranquil consciousness. Self-illuminating consciousness, the only undeniable reality, is foundational. Inactive pure consciousness has neither objects nor content: it is beyond all oppositions, such as that between knower and known.

This outlook reflects the solitary meditator's introverted experience of undifferentiated awareness. It expresses a conviction that behind the world of variability and becoming is a state of changeless pure being that has nothing in common with the processes that we experience.

The appearance of a manifold cosmos consisting of differences between subjects, agents and objects of experience is blamed on a power of illusion or misconception (***avidya***) that generates the misapprehension of the self as a personal agent subject to Vedic social and ritual duties and transmigration (***samsara***). This ignorance is removed by intuitive insight into the identity of the soul and the featureless Absolute beyond oppositions, preceded by the renunciation of agency that presupposes belief in the reality of differences.